THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 01

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one discursive passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Every generation believes that it has invented tiredness, but the truth is that ours is the first to carry a library, a cinema and a post office in its pocket. The mobile phone has made information cheap and quick, and for that we should be grateful. Yet something precious has quietly slipped away: the ability to stay with one thing for a long time.

Reading a book once meant surrendering an afternoon to a single voice. The reader sat still, followed a long argument or a long story, and was changed a little by the end. Today we skim. We read the headline and the first line, we jump to the comments, and we move on before the idea has had time to settle. Researchers who study attention say that the mind behaves like a muscle: it grows strong when it is made to hold a weight for a while, and it grows weak when it is allowed to drop it every few seconds.

Educators have begun to notice the effects of this restlessness in the classroom. Teachers report that students who once could read a chapter in silence now ask whether there is a video summary. This is not laziness; it is the natural result of a mind trained to expect a new picture every few seconds. The good news is that attention can be rebuilt, just as a weak arm is strengthened by lifting small weights each day, and no special equipment is needed except patience and a quiet corner.

This does not mean that screens are enemies. A student who uses a dictionary application to find the meaning of a difficult word is saving time that can be used for thinking. A village girl who watches a video to learn how to repair a pump is gaining a skill that her school could not offer. The trouble begins when the tool starts to decide how we spend our hours. An application that is designed to keep us scrolling is not our servant; it is a very patient salesman.

The remedy is not dramatic. A person who sets aside thirty minutes each day to read something printed, with the phone in another room, will soon find that the restlessness lessens. Libraries still have quiet corners, and a good book has no notifications. The first ten days are the hardest, as with any exercise, but the reward is a mind that can follow a thought to its end.

(i) According to the writer, our generation is special because it: 1

(a) dislikes information
(b) carries a library, cinema and post office in its pocket
(c) has stopped reading altogether
(d) invented tiredness

(ii) 'Surrendering an afternoon to a single voice' means: 1

(a) arguing with someone
(b) giving one's full time to one writer's book
(c) listening to many speakers
(d) losing an afternoon in sleep

(iii) Researchers compare the mind to a muscle because it: 1

(a) gets tired quickly **(b)** cannot be trained
(c) grows strong when it holds a weight for some time **(d)** is always active

(iv) Which example shows a good use of the phone? 1

(a) Reading only headlines **(b)** A girl learning to repair a pump from a video
(c) Playing games in class **(d)** Scrolling for hours at night

(v) The writer calls an application designed to keep us scrolling: 1

(a) a teacher **(b)** a library
(c) a faithful servant **(d)** a very patient salesman

(vi) What has the mobile phone made cheap and quick? 1

(vii) How does the habit of reading today differ from that of the past? 1

(viii) What remedy does the writer suggest? 1

(ix) Find a word from the passage which means 'a medicine or solution'. 1

(x) Find a word from the passage which is the opposite of 'strong'. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage with data/visual input, 200–250 words) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and the table, and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Concerned by the falling number of books borrowed, the club first discussed the matter with the librarian and the class teachers. Members felt that it was unfair to blame students without facts, so they prepared a short questionnaire and spent a week collecting answers during the lunch break. Every response was counted by two members separately to avoid mistakes.

The Reading Club of a school conducted a survey among 200 students of Classes 9 and 10 to find how many minutes a day they spent on different activities.

Activity	Average minutes per day
Screen entertainment	110
Homework and tuition	75
Outdoor play	55
Reading books for pleasure	20

The club presented its findings in the morning assembly. The Principal praised the effort, observing that the figures were more convincing than any lecture, and asked the club to suggest practical steps for the next meeting of the staff council. Several students admitted, a little sheepishly, that they had not touched a storybook since the summer holidays. Members also proposed a 'book swap' corner in the corridor, where any student could leave one book and take another without registering, and a monthly reading hour for each class. The librarian promised to place a small display of new arrivals at the entrance of the library every Monday.

(i) Which activity took the most time per day? 1

(a) Playing outdoors **(b)** Screen entertainment
(c) Reading books **(d)** Homework

(ii) How many minutes a day do students spend reading books for pleasure? 1

(a) 20 **(b)** 60 **(c)** 95 **(d)** 45

(iii) Time spent outdoors is how much less than time spent on homework? 1

(a) 35 minutes **(b)** 10 minutes **(c)** 55 minutes **(d)** 20 minutes

(iv) What is the total time spent daily on homework and reading books? 1

(v) How many students were surveyed? 1

(vi) How many minutes more is spent on screen entertainment than on outdoor play? 1

(vii) What does the survey suggest about the students' reading habit? 1

(viii) Suggest one step the club can take to encourage reading. 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'a study of opinions or habits'. 1

(x) Which group of students was surveyed — boys, girls or both? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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